GRADE 7 PHILIPPINE HISTORY LESSON PLAN

Topic: Pre-Colonial Philippine Society
Time Allotment: 60 Minutes

Learning Objectives
1. Describe the political, social, and cultural life of early Filipinos.
2. Explain the role of the barangay and the datu.
3. Appreciate the achievements of pre-colonial Filipinos.

Lesson
Before the arrival of the Spaniards, Filipinos lived in organized communities called **barangays**. Each barangay was led by a **datu**, who served as the leader, judge, and protector of the community. Early Filipinos had a social structure composed of the **Maharlika** (nobles), **Timawa** (freemen), and **Alipin** (dependents). Their economy was based on farming, fishing, hunting, and trade with neighboring Asian countries such as China and India. Early Filipinos practiced animism, believing that spirits lived in nature. Religious ceremonies were often led by a babaylan. They also developed rich traditions in music, dance, weaving, tattooing, and oral literature.

Procedure
Review prior knowledge about Philippine history. Present images of pre-colonial communities. Discuss the barangay system, social classes, economy, and culture. Conduct a class discussion and allow students to share observations and insights.

Assessment
1. What was the basic political unit of early Filipinos?
2. Who led the barangay?
3. Name the three social classes in pre-colonial society.
4. What economic activities did early Filipinos practice?
5. Why is it important to study pre-colonial Philippine history?

Assignment
Research one pre-colonial kingdom in the Philippines and write a short paragraph describing its culture and government.